GOATS CURD

THE BASICS

MAKE:	Soft
TYPICAL AGE PROFILE:	one week
APPROXIMATE WEIGHT(S):	various
GEOGRAPHICAL ORIGIN:	various
SPECIES OF MILKING ANIMAL:	Goat
BREED OF GOAT:	Breeds not specified
RAW/PASTEURISED MILK:	Examples of both depending on cheesemaker
VEGETARIAN/ANIMAL RENNET:	Examples of both depending on cheesemaker
COMMONLY ENCOUNTERED VARIATIONS:	N/A



THE STORY

If cheese is milks great leap towards immortality, then goats curd is more like the first step. Made to be eaten very young, it is moist and fresh with a milky flavour and silky texture. Goats' milk is high in fat, which means it is particularly good for making creamy curd, although sheep and cows' milk curd is also available. Chefs adore it, using it in everything from salads and tarts to cakes and ice cream.

Made as a lactic cheese, the milk is acidified over several hours until it reaches a pH of around 4.60 and forms a loose, high moisture curd (a small quantity of rennet may also be used). This can be moulded, but is usually drained through cloth, salted (but not always) and packed in tubs. The cheese is typically stored below 8°C to prevent the growth of yeasts and moulds.

THE CHARACTER

Goats curd should have a light, silky texture and fresh clean flavour with some sharpness.

PERFECT PARTNERS:

Crisp white wines such as godello or grüner veltliner match the acidity of the cheese, while the red fruit notes of a Provençal rosé work with the creaminess.

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